

Patrick A. Testa

CONTACT	Tilton Memorial Hall 205, New Orleans, LA 70118 patrickatesta.com	+1 (507) 261 7728 ptesta@tulane.edu
RESEARCH	Political economy, migration, culture, demography, geography, economic history.	
EDUCATION	University of California, Irvine , Irvine, CA Ph.D., Economics 2019 Dissertation: <i>Essays in the Political Economy of Development</i> Committee: Stergios Skaperdas, Daniel Bogart, and Jean-Paul Carvalho M.A., Economics 2015 Loyola University , New Orleans, LA B.B.A., Economics 2014	
EMPLOYMENT	Tulane University , New Orleans, LA Associate Professor of Economics (with tenure) 2026–Present Faculty Affiliate, Murphy Institute 2019–Present Assistant Professor of Economics 2019–2026 Kurzius Family Early Career Professor of Economics 2022–2023 National Bureau of Economic Research , Cambridge, MA Faculty Research Fellow 2025–Present	
ARTICLES, PEER REVIEWED	1. “The Confederate Diaspora” (with Samuel Bazzi, Andreas Ferrara, Martin Fiszbein, and Thomas Pearson), Forthcoming at the <i>Review of Economic Studies</i>. Featured in: <i>VoxEU</i>, <i>USA Today</i>, <i>NBC News</i>, <i>LSE Ballpark</i>, <i>Marginal Revolution</i>, <i>94.1 KPFA</i>. 2. “State Capacity and Identity: Assimilation vs Resistance of Tribal Rimlands,” 2026, <i>European Economic Review</i>, 184, 1–13 (with Stergios Skaperdas). 3. “Political Foundations of Racial Violence in the Post-Reconstruction South,” 2026, <i>Quarterly Journal of Economics</i>, 141, 733–49 (with Jhacova Williams). 4. “National Identity, Public Goods, and Modern Economic Development,” 2025, <i>Journal of Comparative Economics</i>, 53, 412–32 (with Stergios Skaperdas). 5. “New Area- and Population-based Geographic Crosswalks for U.S. Counties and Congressional Districts, 1790–2020,” 2024, <i>Historical Methods</i>, 57, 67–79 (with Andreas Ferrara and Liyang Zhou). 6. “Churches as Social Insurance: Oil Risk and Religion in the U.S. South,” 2023, <i>Journal of Economic History</i>, 83, 786–832 (with Andreas Ferrara). 7. “The Other Great Migration: Southern Whites and the New Right,” 2023, <i>Quarterly Journal of Economics</i>, 138, 1577–1647 (with Samuel Bazzi, Andreas Ferrara, Martin Fiszbein, and Thomas Pearson). Featured in: <i>NPR</i>, <i>The Washington Post</i>, <i>The Economist</i>, <i>Boston Globe</i>, <i>VoxTalks</i>. 8. “The Economic Legacy of Expulsion: Lessons from Post-war Czechoslovakia,” 2021, <i>The Economic Journal</i>, 131, 2233–71. Featured in: <i>The Economic Journal’s</i> “Economics of Conflict” Compilation. 9. “Shocks and the Spatial Distribution of Economic Activity: The Role of Institutions,” 2021, <i>Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization</i>, 183, 791–810. 10. “Education and Propaganda: Tradeoffs to Public Education Provision in Nondemocracies,” 2018, <i>Journal of Public Economics</i>, 160, 66–81.	

ARTICLES,
NON-PEER
REVIEWED

11. “Sundown Towns and Racial Exclusion: The Southern White Diaspora and the ‘Great Retreat’,” 2022, *American Economic Association: Papers and Proceedings*, 112, 234–8 (with Samuel Bazzi, Andreas Ferrara, Martin Fiszbein, and Thomas Pearson).

WORKS
IN PROGRESS

12. “The Winner Premium.”
13. “The Geography of Demographic Composition in the United States” (with Samuel Bazzi, Eric Chyn, Andreas Ferrara, Martin Fiszbein, and Thomas Pearson).
Funded by the [National Science Foundation](#), [Russell Sage Foundation](#), and [CAIDS](#).
14. “The Economic Effects of the 1878 Yellow Fever Epidemic” (with Grace Alster, Samuel Bazzi, and Joshua Graff Zivin).
15. “Jazz” (with Andreas Ferrara, Stephan Heblich, and Joshua Graff Zivin).

PRESENTATIONS,
SINCE 2019

2026: Department Seminar at UN Lincoln (Lincoln, NE), Economic History Seminar at Northwestern (Evanston, IL), Theory, History, and Development Seminar (UCI, Irvine, CA), Department Seminar at Vanderbilt (Nashville, TN), NBER Development of the American Economy Spring Meeting (Cambridge, MA), Economics Lunch Seminar (Tulane, New Orleans, LA), Loyola Economics Club (New Orleans, LA), Ohio University George Washington Forum (New Orleans, LA).

2025: Department Seminar at Ole Miss (Oxford, MS), Department Seminar at UTEP (El Paso, TX, invited but could not attend).

2024: ASSA Meeting (San Antonio, TX), MWEH Conference (Utah State, Logan, UT), ASREC 2024 (Chapman, Orange, CA), EHA Annual Meeting (Sacramento, CA), Department Seminar at UC Merced (Merced, CA, cancelled), Trade and Development Seminar at Boston University (Boston, MA), 94th SEA Meeting (Washington, DC).

2023: Economics Lunch Seminar (Tulane, New Orleans, LA).

2022: Osaka University (virtual), Economics Lunch Seminar (Tulane, New Orleans, LA), University of Pittsburgh (Pittsburgh, PA), ASREC 2022 (Chapman, Orange, CA).

2021: ASSA Meeting (virtual), THPE Reunion Workshop (virtual), 91st SEA Meeting (Houston, TX).

2020: 19th ASREC Meeting* (Chapman, Orange, CA), 95th WEAI Meeting* (Denver), LSU-Tulane Mini-Conference (virtual), Theory, History, and Development Seminar at UCI (virtual), ASREC 24h (virtual), Historical Political Economy Session at the 90th SEA Meeting* (New Orleans, LA), Economic Growth Conference at the 90th SEA Meeting (virtual).
**cancelled due to the COVID-19 pandemic.*

2019: Tulane University (New Orleans, LA), Louisiana State University (Baton Rouge, LA), University of Utah (Salt Lake City, UT), George Mason University (Fairfax, VA), University of Alberta (Edmonton, CA).

COURSES
TAUGHT

Tulane University
ECON 7510: Advanced Price Theory I (Ph.D. level).
ECON 3420: Economic History of the U.S.
ECON 4610/6610: Game Theory.
ECON 4410/6410: Mathematical Economics.
PECN 6000: Political Economy in Historical Perspective.
PECN 6000: Political Economy of Nondemocracy.
PECN 3010: Positive Political Economy.

ADVISING

Tulane University

- Ph.D. Dissertation: Lucia Kovacikova (2022, Marquette University), Gabe Olivier (2026, Florida State University), Alejandro Gonzalez Tapia (expected 2028), Nan Zhang (expected 2028).
- Undergraduate Honors Thesis: Grace Slapak* (2021), Mary-Crescent Carter* (2022), Ellie Stevenson (2025), Mika Nijhawan* (2025), Hope Breslin (2026), Scarlett Seyler* (2026), Aiyana Brumley* (2026), Kloe Godard (2027).
- Undergraduate Independent Studies: Benjamin Ferrell (2026), Georgia May (2026), Kenneth Munroe (2026).
- Major Advising: 19 current major advisees, with 41 total between 2019 and 2025.

**chaired or co-chaired.*

UNIVERSITY SERVICE

Tulane University

- Navigating tenure (with Elliott Isaac), Economics junior faculty meeting 2026
- Faculty advisor and speaker, Summer Research Program 2025
- Co-organizer, Economics Seminar Series 2024–2025
- Creator, Economics “internships and careers” monthly email blast Since 2022
- Hiring committee member, Economics-Murphy joint hire 2022
- Organizer, Economics Lunch Seminar Series 2021–2023
- Creator (with LaPorchia Collins), [Economics internships and careers page](#) 2021
- Faculty board member, Tulane Journal of Policy & Political Economy Since 2020
- Exam coordinator (with Wei Long), Economics Ph.D. qualifying exams Since 2020
- Interviewer, Murphy Institute director search 2020
- Mock interviewer, Economics job market candidates Since 2019

REFEREEING

American Economic Review, American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, Czech Science Foundation, Economics of Governance, Economic Inquiry, Economic Journal, European Economic Review, Explorations in Economic History, Independent Review, Moravian Geographical Reports, Journal of Comparative Economics, Journal of Development Economics, Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization, Journal of Economic History, Journal of Economics, Race, and Policy, Journal of the European Economic Association, Journal of Labor Economics, Journal of Population Economics, Journal of Public Economics, Journal of Regional Science, Public Choice, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Review of Economics and Statistics, Review of Economic Studies, Tulane Journal of Policy and Political Economy.

CONFERENCE SERVICE

Session Chair

- 2024:** 9th SEA Meeting (Washington, DC)
- 2023:** ASSA Annual Meeting (New Orleans, LA)

Discussant

- 2024:** ASSA Annual Meeting (San Antonio, TX)
- 2023:** ASSA Annual Meeting (New Orleans, LA)
- 2022:** Economic History Association Meeting (La Crosse, WI)
- 2021:** Economic History Association Meeting (Tucson, AZ)
- 2019:** Economic History Association Meeting (Atlanta, GA)
- 2018:** Urban Economics Association Meeting (Columbia, New York, NY)
- 2018:** IRES Workshop (Chapman, Orange, CA)
- 2018:** 17th ASREC Meeting (Chapman, Orange, CA)
- 2017:** Public Choice Society Meeting (New Orleans, LA)
- 2017:** 16th ASREC Meeting (Boston, MA)

OTHER
PROFESSIONAL
SERVICE

Data

- County-to-county and county-to-CD crosswalks, 1790–2020: [DOI](#). Featured on [Best of #EconTwitter](#) (Oct. 24, 2021).

Teaching

- Teaching material for geographic crosswalks: [DOI](#).

GRANTS AND
AWARDS

Tulane University

- Data, AI, and Community Research Grant (\$2,500), [CAIDS](#) 2025
- NSF Research Grant (\$353,568), *National Science Foundation* 2025–2027
Funding “The Geography of Demographic Composition in the United States” (with Samuel Bazzi, Eric Chyn, Andreas Ferrara, Martin Fiszbein, and Thomas Pearson)
- Schloss Prize (\$2,500), *Department of Economics* 2022, 2024
- RSF Research Grant (\$195,022), *Russell Sage Foundation* 2024–2026
“The Geography of Race and Ethnicity in the United States: Uncovering a Hidden History of Expulsion and Exclusion” (with Samuel Bazzi, Eric Chyn, Andreas Ferrara, Martin Fiszbein, and Thomas Pearson)
- Carol Lavin Bernick Faculty Grant (\$7,000), *Tulane University* 2023–2024
- Kurzius Family Early Career Professorship (\$6,500), *School of Liberal Arts* 2022–2023

University of California, Irvine

- Romney Award for Outstanding Research Paper, *School of Social Sciences* 2019
- Kassouf Fellowship for Excellence in Research, *Department of Economics* 2018
- Christian Werner Fellowship, *School of Social Sciences* 2018
- Student Fellowship Award, *Public Choice Society* 2017
- Art DeVany Best Poster Award, *Department of Economics* 2016
- Economics Merit Fellowship, *Department of Economics* 2016, 2018
- Summer Research Fellowship, *Department of Economics* 2016–2018
- Distinction in Microeconomics, *Department of Economics* 2015
- Humane Studies Fellowship, *Institute for Humane Studies* 2014–2018
- Merit Fellowship in Economics, *Department of Economics* 2014–2019